SOP-SHL-04

Shelter Check

Find and verify your nearest shelters BEFORE you need them

Identify Shelters

- [ ] **Nearest public shelter — location identified** — Check municipality website, building committee, or neighbours
- [ ] **Second nearest shelter — location identified** — Backup in case primary is locked or full
- [ ] **Third nearest shelter — location identified** — May be a public building with a Mamam
- [ ] **Building stairwell assessed as fallback** — Windowless? Which floor is safest? Clear of obstacles?

Verify Access

- [ ] **Primary shelter — physically visited and confirmed accessible** — Some shelters are locked; verify you can get in or know who has the key
- [ ] **Secondary shelter — physically visited and confirmed accessible**
- [ ] **Opening hours / access restrictions known** — Some shelters are locked at night or require a code
- [ ] **Key holder or access code obtained (if applicable)** — Building committee, municipality, or designated keyholder
- [ ] **Shelter is maintained and usable** — Not used as storage, flooded, or blocked — report issues to municipality

Know the Route

- [ ] **Route to primary shelter — walked and timed** — Can you make it within your area's time-to-shelter?
- [ ] **Route to secondary shelter — walked and timed**
- [ ] **Route walked at night** — Is it lit? Can you navigate it in the dark with a torch?
- [ ] **Route is step-free or accessible (if needed)** — Kerbs, stairs, uneven ground — can everyone in your household make it?
- [ ] **Obstacles identified and noted** — Locked gates, construction, narrow passages

Time to Shelter

- [ ] **Time to shelter for your area — looked up and memorised** — Check HFC Alerts tab at oref.org.il — enter your locality name
- [ ] **Realistic time test completed** — Timed yourself and family at a fast walk, not a sprint
- [ ] **If shelter NOT reachable in time — fallback plan set** — Inner stairwell or inner room identified and prepared

DISCLAIMER: Not an official government resource. Use at your own risk. Based on HFC (Pikud HaOref) publications as of 12 Mar 2026. Official guidance: oref.org.il.